

someone might look over your shoulder one day and say, “Wow, that’s some beautiful code!”

Simple is better than complex.

If you have a choice between a simple and a complex solution, and both work, use the simple solution. Your code will be easier to maintain, and it will be easier for you and others to build on that code later on.

Complex is better than complicated.

Real life is messy, and sometimes a simple solution to a problem is unattainable. In that case, use the simplest solution that works.

Readability counts.

Even when your code is complex, aim to make it readable. When you’re working on a project that involves complex coding, focus on writing informative comments for that code.

There should be one-- and preferably only one --obvious way to do it.

If two Python programmers are asked to solve the same problem, they should come up with fairly compatible solutions. This is not to say there’s no room for creativity in programming. On the contrary, there is plenty of room for creativity! However, much of programming consists of using small, common approaches to simple situations within a larger, more creative project. The nuts and bolts of your programs should make sense to other Python programmers.

Now is better than never.

You could spend the rest of your life learning all the intricacies of Python and of programming in general, but then you’d never complete any projects. Don’t try to write perfect code; write code that works, and then decide whether to improve your code for that project or move on to something new.

As you continue to the next chapter and start digging into more involved topics, try to keep this philosophy of simplicity and clarity in mind. Experienced programmers will respect your code more and will be happy to give you feedback and collaborate with you on interesting projects.

TRY IT YOURSELF

2-12. Zen of Python: Enter `import this` into a Python terminal session and skim through the additional principles.